BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Monday 26 Oct 2026, 07:50 Malaysia time (23:50 UTC Sun)

BTC ~ $80,400

Kraken live: -0.2% 24h | week ~-1.8% (Coinbase)

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, slight bearish tilt	**Next 24h range:** $79,000 - $81,800	**Key floor:** $79,100 (Sat low), then $78,000	**Big event:** FOMC Thu 29 Oct 02:00 MYT; $11B expiry Fri 30 Oct

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

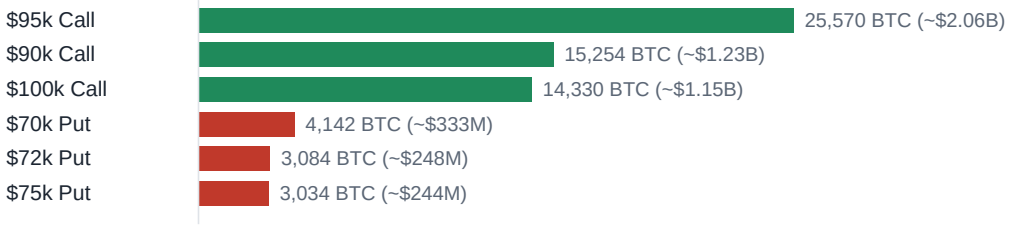
- Next expiry: **daily 26OCT26 at 4:00pm MYT today** (08:00 UTC). Daily expiries are small; strike-level data for it could not be read this run, so treat its impact as minor.
- The expiry that matters this week is the **Friday 30 Oct monthly (also the weekly), 4:00pm MYT**: about **$11B notional, ~136,000 BTC**, roughly a third of Deribit BTC options open interest.
- Put/call about **0.55** (calls dominate), max pain about **$78,000-$79,000**, the **$95,000 call** is the single biggest strike.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
26 Oct daily (4pm MYT)	Not readable this run	Small (daily)	Little hedging pressure today; spot drivers dominate
30 Oct monthly - call	$95,000 Call	25,570 BTC (~$2.06B)	Far out of the money (~18% above spot); likely expires worthless, no near-term pull
30 Oct monthly - put	$70,000 Put	4,142 BTC (~$333M)	Downside insurance well below spot; only relevant in a crash

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Mon 26 Oct 4:00pm (daily)	n/a (small)	n/a	n/a	Data not readable this run
Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm (weekly + monthly)	~$11B (136k BTC)	~0.55	~$78,000 (Deribit est. $76k-79k)	Calls $95k / $90k / $100k; puts $70k / $72k / $75k
Fri 6 Nov 4:00pm (weekly)	n/a	n/a	n/a	Not yet reported
Fri 27 Nov 4:00pm (monthly)	~26,779 BTC (~$2.15B)	n/a	n/a	Not yet reported
Fri 25 Dec 4:00pm (quarterly)	~$10B	n/a	~$75,000 (as of 30 Sep)	Not yet reported

30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry - largest open interest by strike (Deribit, CryptoTicker 17 Oct)



How options affect the market now

- **Today's daily expiry is too small to move price**; spot flow, weekend-liquidation aftermath and macro headlines dominate the next 24h.
- **Max pain ($78k-$79k) sits just below spot.** Into Friday there can be a mild gravitational pull lower, but max pain is a tendency, not a target.
- **The big call strikes ($90k-$100k) are far away**, so they create no resistance wall now; they mostly show leftover bullish bets that will likely expire worthless.

- **Put strikes cluster at $70k-$75k.** If BTC breaks below ~$78k, dealers short those puts would sell to hedge, which can accelerate a drop.
- **Put/call ~0.55 is call-heavy** by count, but much of it is stale upside; near-term sentiment is more cautious (Fear and Greed 40).
- At-the-money IV ~32% implies about **+/-1.7% a day (~$1,350)**. Volatility tends to drop after Friday's expiry unless the Fed surprises.

Data note: the Deribit API could not be read this run, so strike sizes come from published reports (CryptoTicker 17 Oct; EthNews 25 Oct) and are 'largest seen'. USD sizes = OI x $80,400. Strike OI may have shifted since 17 Oct.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC dropped below $80,000 on Saturday to **$79,107-$79,146**, its lowest in over a month, as the US cut embassy staff in the Middle East and Brent oil topped $116.
- About **$815-820M** of crypto positions were liquidated in 24h, ~84% longs; BTC longs alone ~$223M.
- Price recovered to ~$80,800-$80,900 on Sunday and now trades ~**$80,400** (Kraken), CoinGecko shows ~$79,900 (-1.1% 24h).
- BTC sits below the 20-day (~$82,500) and 50-day (~$81,700-$81,800) averages but well above the 200-day (~$72,900). Week range $79,107-$84,856.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,300-$84,900	Last week's high (21 Oct); clean break would flip trend up
Resistance 1	$81,500-$82,500	50-day and 20-day averages; recent breakdown zone
Pivot	$80,000-$80,500	Round number and largest hedge level for Friday expiry
Support	$79,100-$79,300	Saturday's low after the liquidation flush
Support 2	$77,600-$78,400	Max pain ~$78k and lower edge of options implied range
Deep risk	$75,000-$76,000	Put cluster and prior support; hedging could accelerate a drop

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Implied vol (ATM)	~32% (DVOL 38.3 on 20 Oct)	Implied daily move ~1.7%; options pricing more movement than realised
Funding (perps)	~0.0049% / 8h (22 Oct)	Near neutral; leverage cleared by weekend flush
Futures open interest	Crypto total $140.1B, -2.2% 24h	Deleveraging after liquidations
Liquidations 24h	~$815-820M total; ~84% longs	Longs washed out; reduces forced selling near term
Spot BTC ETF flows	22 Oct -$635.6M; 23 Oct -$137.9M	Largest outflow since June; week still +$301M, October ~-$314M
Fear and Greed	40 (Fear)	Down from 55 a week earlier; cautious mood

4. News and macro

- **Geopolitics/oil:** US cut staff at Middle East embassies; Brent hit ~$117 on Houthi attacks, feeding inflation worries and risk-off moves.
- **Fed:** FOMC meets 27-28 Oct; ~90% priced for a hold at 3.75-4.00% after September's 25bp hike; ~9% chance of another hike. September CPI was 3.7% y/y.
- **ETF outflows:** spot BTC ETFs lost $635.6M on 22 Oct and $137.9M on 23 Oct, erasing October gains.

- **Treasuries:** Strategy and Strive added ~1,490 BTC combined, but preferred-dividend costs may limit future buying. SpaceX and Tesla confirmed merger talks covering 30,000+ BTC.
- **Security/regulation:** Keystone disclosed a customer data breach (keys safe, phishing risk); Switzerland approved its first retail spot BTC ETF; a Chinese court moved to confiscate 61,896 BTC.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Mon 26 Oct 4:00pm	Deribit daily options expiry
Thu 29 Oct 2:00am / 2:30am	FOMC decision / Powell press conference (hold expected)
Thu 29 Oct ~4:00am	Microsoft, Alphabet earnings (after US close 28 Oct)
Thu 29 Oct	BTC mining difficulty adjustment (est. +5%)
Thu 29 Oct 8:30pm	US PCE inflation and advance Q3 GDP
Thu 29 Oct evening	ECB rate decision
Fri 30 Oct ~4:00am	Amazon, Coinbase, Strategy earnings
Fri 30 Oct	Bank of Japan decision
Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm	Deribit monthly expiry (~$11B BTC)
Fri 30 Oct 11:00pm	CME bitcoin futures settlement
Sun 1 Nov	US clocks change to winter time (US releases shift +1h in MYT)
Tue 3 Nov	US midterm elections
Fri 6 Nov 9:30pm (expected)	US jobs report for October
Wed 9 Dec / Thu 10 Dec 3:00am	Next FOMC (8-9 Dec)

5. Summary and prediction

BTC is stabilising around $80,000 after a weekend liquidation flush that cleared ~$690M of long leverage. Funding is neutral and leverage is lighter, which lowers the risk of another forced cascade, but ETF outflows, $117 oil and a hawkish-leaning Fed keep buyers cautious. Today's options expiry is minor; the real event week is Thursday's FOMC and PCE followed by Friday's $11B monthly expiry, with max pain at $78k-$79k just below spot. Expect a choppy pre-Fed range with dips toward $79k likely bought and rallies capped near the 50-day average. **24h call: range $79,000-$81,800, mild downside bias while below $81,800.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: pre-Fed range	55%	$79,000 - $81,800	No new shock; traders wait for FOMC, liquidity thin in Asia
Bullish: reclaim 50-day	20%	$81,800 - $83,500	Hourly close above $81,800, ETF inflows return, oil eases
Bearish: retest lows	25%	$77,600 - $79,100	Loss of $79,100 on Middle East escalation or more ETF outflows; put hedging below $78k

- Breakout up: 4h close above **$81,800** with rising spot volume opens $83,500-$84,800.
- Breakdown: hourly close below **$79,100** opens $78,000 (max pain) and then $76,000.
- Next report: 3:50pm MYT (Mon 26 Oct)

Sources

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